

Daily Mode 2026 UPSC Current Affairs - February 2026

Date range: February 1, 2026 to February 28, 2026

Confidence: High

Step 1 - Source Transparency

Field	Detail
Date range used	February 1, 2026 to February 28, 2026
Common window used	Monthly PRS review plus linked official notifications, judgments, and ministry releases
Sources used	PRS Monthly Policy Review, February 2026; Union Budget 2026-27, Government of India; RBI Monetary Policy Committee statement, February 2026; RBI draft revised master direction on credit derivatives; MoSPI new GDP series release, 2025-26; Budget proposals on Semiconductor Mission 2.0, Biopharma SHAKTI, and banking committee
Unavailable sources	No consolidated all-sector official monthly digest
Verification confidence	High
Source disagreement detected	No source disagreement detected.
PDF export available through pdf	Yes, this month bundle

Step 2 - Current Affairs Master List

No.	Current Affair	Theme	Subject	Philosophy Optional Link	Philosophy Theme	GS Mapping	Why in News - 1 Line	Priority	Suggested Depth
1	First half of the Budget Session concludes	Parliament / session	Polity	Possible	Parliamentary democracy	GS II	The first half of the Budget Session concluded after the President's Address, Economic Survey, and the Union Budget cycle.	Medium	Standard
2	Union Budget 2026-27 presented	Fiscal policy	Economy	Possible	Distributive justice	GS III	The Finance Minister presented the 2026-27 Union Budget with expenditure, receipts, deficits, and several policy proposals.	High	Deep
3	India's GDP estimated to grow by 7.6% in 2025-26	National accounts	Economy	No	No strong direct link	GS III	MoSPI released the new GDP series with 2022-23 as the base year and projected growth at 7.6%.	High	Basic
4	Repo rate maintained at 5.25%	Monetary policy	Economy	No	No strong direct link	GS III	The RBI MPC kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and left the stance neutral.	High	Basic
5	RBI releases draft revised master direction on credit derivatives	Financial markets	Economy	Possible	Fairness and risk allocation	GS III	The RBI drafted a framework for total return swaps and credit default swaps on corporate bonds.	High	Standard
6	Tax proposals and Budget policy changes	Direct tax / market policy	Economy	Possible	Distributive justice	GS III	The Budget kept most tax rates unchanged but changed securities transaction tax and granted a tax holiday for foreign cloud-service companies using Indian data centres.	Medium	Standard
7	High-level Committee on Banking for Viksit Bharat	Banking reform	Economy	Possible	Economic justice	GS III	The Budget announced a high-level committee to review the banking sector for Viksit Bharat.	Medium	Standard
8	Semiconductor Mission 2.0	Strategic manufacturing	Sci-Tech / Economy	Possible	Scientific temper	GS III	The Budget proposed Semiconductor Mission 2.0 to expand India's semiconductor ecosystem.	High	Standard
9	Biopharma SHAKTI scheme	Biotech policy	Sci-Tech / Economy	Possible	Scientific temper	GS III	The Budget proposed Biopharma SHAKTI to support domestic biologics production for five years.	Medium	Standard
10	Revival of legacy industrial clusters scheme	Industrial policy	Economy	Possible	Economic justice	GS III	The Budget proposed a scheme to revive around 200 legacy industrial clusters.	Medium	Basic

Step 3 - Recommended Order of Study

Study Order	Current Affair	Priority	Recommended Depth	Why Study in This Order?	Static Theory Need	Mains Need	Philosophy Optional Need
1	First half of the Budget Session concludes	Medium	Standard	The first half of the Budget Session concluded after the President's Address, Economic Survey, and the Union Budget cycle.	High	Medium	Medium

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Study Order	Current Affair	Priority	Recommended Depth	Why Study in This Order?	Static Theory Need	Mains Need	Philosophy Optional Need
2	Union Budget 2026-27 presented	High	Deep	The Finance Minister presented the 2026-27 Union Budget with expenditure, receipts, deficits, and several policy proposals.	High	High	Medium
3	India's GDP estimated to grow by 7.6% in 2025-26	High	Basic	MoSPI released the new GDP series with 2022-23 as the base year and projected growth at 7.6%.	High	Medium	Low
4	Repo rate maintained at 5.25%	High	Basic	The RBI MPC kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and left the stance neutral.	High	Medium	Low
5	RBI releases draft revised master direction on credit derivatives	High	Standard	The RBI drafted a framework for total return swaps and credit default swaps on corporate bonds.	High	Medium	Medium
6	Tax proposals and Budget policy changes	Medium	Standard	The Budget kept most tax rates unchanged but changed securities transaction tax and granted a tax holiday for foreign cloud-service companies using Indian data centres.	High	Medium	Medium
7	High-level Committee on Banking for Viksit Bharat	Medium	Standard	The Budget announced a high-level committee to review the banking sector for Viksit Bharat.	High	Medium	Medium
8	Semiconductor Mission 2.0	High	Standard	The Budget proposed Semiconductor Mission 2.0 to expand India's semiconductor ecosystem.	Medium	Medium	Medium
9	Biopharma SHAKTI scheme	Medium	Standard	The Budget proposed Biopharma SHAKTI to support domestic biologics production for five years.	Medium	Medium	Medium
10	Revival of legacy industrial clusters scheme	Medium	Basic	The Budget proposed a scheme to revive around 200 legacy industrial clusters.	High	Medium	Medium

Step 4 - Study Order Choice

Would you like to continue in this recommended order and depth, or choose your own topic order and depth?

1. Continue with recommended order and depth
2. Keep the recommended order but change depth
3. Choose my own topic order and depth
4. Show full detailed notes for all current affairs in the recommended order
5. Type pdf to download the completed list and recommended order as a PDF

Current Affair 1: First half of the Budget Session concludes

Theme: Parliament / session

Subject: Polity

GS Mapping: GS II

Priority: Medium | Suggested Depth: Standard

Source hook: The first half of the Budget Session concluded after the President's Address, Economic Survey, and the Union Budget cycle.

Facts

- The session ended its first phase after the Budget was presented.
- This is useful for chronology questions on Parliament.
- Budget, survey, and debate sequence matter in prelims.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The session ended its first	The session ended its first phase after the Budget was presented.	Prelims / Mains
This is useful for chronolog	This is useful for chronology questions on Parliament.	Prelims / Mains
Budget, survey, and debate s	Budget, survey, and debate sequence matter in prelims.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The first half of the Budget Session concluded after the President's Address, Economic Survey, and the Union Budget cycle.
Historical / institutional background	This links to constitutional design, parliamentary scrutiny, institutional balance, and rights-based governance.
Legal / institutional origin	Parliamentary session chronology and Budget process
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Prior constitutional and statutory framework existed; 2026: New update or judgment
Static linkage	Parliament, Constitution, federalism, separation of powers, and legislative procedure.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS II and mains answers on institutions, accountability, and democratic legitimacy.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Prior constitutional and statutory framework existed	Shows the earlier legal baseline
2026	New update or judgment	Current policy trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Polity	Parliament	Parliament, Constitution, federalism, separation of powers, and legislative procedure.
Polity	Parliament / session	Very useful for GS II and mains answers on institutions, accountability, and democratic legitimacy.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Parliamentary session chronology and Budget process	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains
Polity	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
BE	Budget Estimate	Initial fiscal projection	Parliament / Economy

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not mix up the first half with the full session.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not forget the recess and later reconvening.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it to anchor the annual Budget process.	GS II	Parliament / session
Analytical point	It is a procedural current affair with repeated utility.	GS II	Parliament / session

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: constitutional and legislative basics	Static syllabus link: constitutional and legislative basics	High
Revision link	Revision link: article, act, rule, and institution mapping	Revision link: article, act, rule, and institution mapping	High
Current affairs link	First half of the Budget Session concludes	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Polity	Parliamentary democracy	It illustrates legislative time management and scrutiny.	Use as an example of procedural democracy.	GS II	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: It illustrates legislative time management and scrutiny. Use as an example of procedural democracy.

Revision Notes

- The session ended its first phase after the Budget was presented.
- This is useful for chronology questions on Parliament.
- Use it to anchor the annual Budget process.

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Current Affair 2: Union Budget 2026-27 presented

Theme: Fiscal policy

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: High | **Suggested Depth:** Deep

Source hook: The Finance Minister presented the 2026-27 Union Budget with expenditure, receipts, deficits, and several policy proposals.

Facts

- Total expenditure was projected at Rs 53,47,315 crore.
- Fiscal deficit was targeted at 4.3% of GDP.
- Tax rates were broadly unchanged while policy proposals were expanded.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
Total expenditure was projec	Total expenditure was projected at Rs 53,47,315 crore.	Prelims / Mains
Fiscal deficit was targeted	Fiscal deficit was targeted at 4.3% of GDP.	Prelims / Mains
Tax rates were broadly uncha	Tax rates were broadly unchanged while policy proposals were expanded.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Finance Minister presented the 2026-27 Union Budget with expenditure, receipts, deficits, and several policy proposals.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	Annual fiscal statement and Finance Bill
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Fiscal policy	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Annual fiscal statement and Finance Bill	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
STT	Securities Transaction Tax	Tax rate changed on derivatives	Finance

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not confuse budget estimates with revised estimates.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not quote headline numbers without the fiscal ratio.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for fiscal consolidation, spending priorities, and policy signalling.	GS III	Fiscal policy
Analytical point	It is one of the year's highest-value economy topics.	GS III	Fiscal policy

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	Union Budget 2026-27 presented	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Economy	Distributive justice	The ethical question is how the state allocates scarce public resources.	The link is direct enough for essay and ethics framing.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The ethical question is how the state allocates scarce public resources. The link is direct enough for essay and ethics framing. One line: a budget is a moral map of state priorities.

Revision Notes

- Total expenditure was projected at Rs 53,47,315 crore.
- Fiscal deficit was targeted at 4.3% of GDP.
- Use it for fiscal consolidation, spending priorities, and policy signalling.

Current Affair 3: India's GDP estimated to grow by 7.6% in 2025-26

Theme: National accounts

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: High | Suggested Depth: Basic

Source hook: MoSPI released the new GDP series with 2022-23 as the base year and projected growth at 7.6%.

Facts

- The new series changed the base year to 2022-23.
- It estimated GDP at current prices around Rs 345 lakh crore.
- The release is essential for national accounts revision.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The new series changed the b	The new series changed the base year to 2022-23.	Prelims / Mains
It estimated GDP at current	It estimated GDP at current prices around Rs 345 lakh crore.	Prelims / Mains
The release is essential for	The release is essential for national accounts revision.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	MoSPI released the new GDP series with 2022-23 as the base year and projected growth at 7.6%.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	New GDP series and base-year revision
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	National accounts	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
New GDP series and base-year revision	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
GDP	Gross Domestic Product	Output measure	Economy
Base year	2022-23	Reference year for the series	Economy

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not confuse the series update with the actual economy changing overnight.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not mix current prices with constant prices.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for GDP, base year, and growth measurement.	GS III	National accounts
Analytical point	It is a compact prelims topic with strong factual value.	GS III	National accounts

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	India's GDP estimated to grow by 7.6% in 2025-26	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

No strong Philosophy Optional linkage identified for this current affair. Do not force an artificial connection.

Revision Notes

- The new series changed the base year to 2022-23.
- It estimated GDP at current prices around Rs 345 lakh crore.
- Use it for GDP, base year, and growth measurement.

Current Affair 4: Repo rate maintained at 5.25%

Theme: Monetary policy

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: High | Suggested Depth: Basic

Source hook: The RBI MPC kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and left the stance neutral.

Facts

- The standing deposit facility rate and bank rate were also unchanged.
- This is a recurring RBI policy-rate update.
- It matters for inflation-growth balance and transmission.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The standing deposit facilit	The standing deposit facility rate and bank rate were also unchanged.	Prelims / Mains
This is a recurring RBI poli	This is a recurring RBI policy-rate update.	Prelims / Mains
It matters for inflation-gro	It matters for inflation-growth balance and transmission.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The RBI MPC kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and left the stance neutral.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	RBI MPC policy-rate decision
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Monetary policy	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
RBI MPC policy-rate decision	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
MPC	Monetary Policy Committee	RBI's rate-setting body	Economy

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not confuse repo with reverse repo or bank rate.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not ignore the stance decision.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for monetary policy and price stability questions.	GS III	Monetary policy
Analytical point	It is a dependable one-minute revision fact.	GS III	Monetary policy

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	Repo rate maintained at 5.25%	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

No strong Philosophy Optional linkage identified for this current affair. Do not force an artificial connection.

Revision Notes

- The standing deposit facility rate and bank rate were also unchanged.
- This is a recurring RBI policy-rate update.
- Use it for monetary policy and price stability questions.

Current Affair 5: RBI releases draft revised master direction on credit derivatives

Theme: Financial markets

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: High | Suggested Depth: Standard

Source hook: The RBI drafted a framework for total return swaps and credit default swaps on corporate bonds.

Facts

- The framework aims to deepen bond market derivatives.
- It follows the Budget's reference to corporate bond derivatives.
- It is important for financial market regulation.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The framework aims to deepen	The framework aims to deepen bond market derivatives.	Prelims / Mains
It follows the Budget's refe	It follows the Budget's reference to corporate bond derivatives.	Prelims / Mains
It is important for financia	It is important for financial market regulation.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The RBI drafted a framework for total return swaps and credit default swaps on corporate bonds.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	Credit derivatives regulation and bond-market deepening
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Financial markets	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Credit derivatives regulation and bond-market deepening	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
TRS	Total Return Swap	Derivative on bond returns	Finance
CDS	Credit Default Swap	Protection against credit events	Finance

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not confuse TRS with CDS.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not treat derivatives as only speculation; they also manage risk.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for capital markets, risk management, and financial development.	GS III	Financial markets
Analytical point	It is useful in GS III financial sector answers.	GS III	Financial markets

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	RBI releases draft revised master direction on credit derivatives	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Economy	Fairness and risk allocation	The philosophy link is indirect through fairness in financial risk-sharing.	Use it lightly as a market design example.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The philosophy link is indirect through fairness in financial risk-sharing. Use it lightly as a market design example. Do not over-philosophise a technical RBI notice.

Revision Notes

- The framework aims to deepen bond market derivatives.
- It follows the Budget's reference to corporate bond derivatives.
- Use it for capital markets, risk management, and financial development.

Current Affair 6: Tax proposals and Budget policy changes

Theme: Direct tax / market policy

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: Medium | Suggested Depth: Standard

Source hook: The Budget kept most tax rates unchanged but changed securities transaction tax and granted a tax holiday for foreign cloud-service companies using Indian data centres.

Facts

- Tax policy changes were narrow but targeted.
- The cloud-service tax holiday is a tech-investment signal.
- This is useful for budget analysis beyond the headline deficit.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
Tax policy changes were narr	Tax policy changes were narrow but targeted.	Prelims / Mains
The cloud-service tax holida	The cloud-service tax holiday is a tech-investment signal.	Prelims / Mains
This is useful for budget an	This is useful for budget analysis beyond the headline deficit.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Budget kept most tax rates unchanged but changed securities transaction tax and granted a tax holiday for foreign cloud-service companies using Indian data centres.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	Tax policy adjustments inside the Union Budget
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Direct tax / market policy	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Tax policy adjustments inside the Union Budget	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
STT	Securities Transaction Tax	Market tax adjusted in Budget	Finance

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not assume the whole budget was a tax shock budget.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not miss the sector-specific cloud data-centre incentive.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for tax policy, investment promotion, and market impact.	GS III	Direct tax / market policy
Analytical point	It adds nuance to budget revision notes.	GS III	Direct tax / market policy

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	Tax proposals and Budget policy changes	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Economy	Distributive justice	The ethical question is who bears tax burden and who receives incentives.	Use this as an example of policy targeting rather than moral theory.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The ethical question is who bears tax burden and who receives incentives. Use this as an example of policy targeting rather than moral theory. It is best as a small supporting point.

Revision Notes

- Tax policy changes were narrow but targeted.
- The cloud-service tax holiday is a tech-investment signal.
- Use it for tax policy, investment promotion, and market impact.

Current Affair 7: High-level Committee on Banking for Viksit Bharat

Theme: Banking reform

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: Medium | Suggested Depth: Standard

Source hook: The Budget announced a high-level committee to review the banking sector for Viksit Bharat.

Facts

- The committee signals structural banking reform.
- It matters for financial inclusion and credit efficiency.
- The issue is a classic policy follow-up from the Budget.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The committee signals struct	The committee signals structural banking reform.	Prelims / Mains
It matters for financial inc	It matters for financial inclusion and credit efficiency.	Prelims / Mains
The issue is a classic polic	The issue is a classic policy follow-up from the Budget.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Budget announced a high-level committee to review the banking sector for Viksit Bharat.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	Banking sector reform committee announced in the Budget
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Banking reform	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Daily Mode 2026 UPSC Current Affairs - February 2026

Date range: February 1, 2026 to February 28, 2026

Confidence: High

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Banking sector reform committee announced in the Budget	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
Viksit Bharat	Developed India	Policy goal framing	Economy

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not treat this as an actual law or notification.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not ignore that it is an agenda-setting committee.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for banking reform, financial intermediation, and policy direction.	GS III	Banking reform
Analytical point	It is a good mains add-on in economy answers.	GS III	Banking reform

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	High-level Committee on Banking for Viksit Bharat	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Economy	Economic justice	The link is indirect through access to credit and institutional design.	Use it as a state-capacity example.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The link is indirect through access to credit and institutional design. Use it as a state-capacity example. Keep the philosophy angle light.

Revision Notes

- The committee signals structural banking reform.
- It matters for financial inclusion and credit efficiency.
- Use it for banking reform, financial intermediation, and policy direction.

Current Affair 8: Semiconductor Mission 2.0

Theme: Strategic manufacturing

Subject: Sci-Tech / Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Source hook: The Budget proposed Semiconductor Mission 2.0 to expand India’s semiconductor ecosystem.

Facts

- The focus is ecosystem building, not only one-off subsidies.
- It links to strategic autonomy and manufacturing depth.
- It is central to tech industrial policy.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The focus is ecosystem build	The focus is ecosystem building, not only one-off subsidies.	Prelims / Mains
It links to strategic autono	It links to strategic autonomy and manufacturing depth.	Prelims / Mains
It is central to tech indust	It is central to tech industrial policy.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Budget proposed Semiconductor Mission 2.0 to expand India’s semiconductor ecosystem.
Historical / institutional background	This links to technology governance, innovation, industrial policy, and digital regulation.
Legal / institutional origin	Semiconductor policy under the Budget
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Earlier tech or industrial policy framework; 2026: New tech-related policy or bill
Static linkage	Science and technology policy, digital regulation, AI, data, semiconductors, and industrial ecosystems.
UPSC relevance	Useful for GS III and for future-oriented mains answers on innovation and regulation.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Earlier tech or industrial policy framework	Sets the base
2026	New tech-related policy or bill	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Sci-Tech / Economy	Science and technology policy	Science and technology policy, digital regulation, AI, data, semiconductors, and industrial ecosystems.
Tech	Strategic manufacturing	Useful for GS III and for future-oriented mains answers on innovation and regulation.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Semiconductor policy under the Budget	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Confidence: High

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Sci-Tech / Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
SEMICON	Semiconductor Mission	National chip ecosystem initiative	Technology

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not reduce chip policy to one fab plant.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not ignore design, packaging, and supply-chain layers.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for self-reliance, tech policy, and industrial strategy.	GS III	Strategic manufacturing
Analytical point	It is a strong GS III current affair.	GS III	Strategic manufacturing

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: science, tech, and innovation policy	Static syllabus link: science, tech, and innovation policy	High
Revision link	Revision link: ecosystem, regulation, and strategic autonomy	Revision link: ecosystem, regulation, and strategic autonomy	High
Current affairs link	Semiconductor Mission 2.0	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Tech	Scientific temper	Use only as a philosophy-of-science illustration.	The link is about reasoned innovation and capability building.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: Use only as a philosophy-of-science illustration. The link is about reasoned innovation and capability building. Do not force a philosophical reading.

Revision Notes

- The focus is ecosystem building, not only one-off subsidies.
- It links to strategic autonomy and manufacturing depth.
- Use it for self-reliance, tech policy, and industrial strategy.

Current Affair 9: Biopharma SHAKTI scheme

Theme: Biotech policy

Subject: Sci-Tech / Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: Medium | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Source hook: The Budget proposed Biopharma SHAKTI to support domestic biologics production for five years.

Facts

- The scheme aims to strengthen domestic biologics and biomanufacturing.
- It is relevant for pharma resilience and innovation.
- This is a strong science-policy current affair.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
The scheme aims to strengthe	The scheme aims to strengthen domestic biologics and biomanufacturing.	Prelims / Mains
It is relevant for pharma re	It is relevant for pharma resilience and innovation.	Prelims / Mains
This is a strong science-pol	This is a strong science-policy current affair.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Budget proposed Biopharma SHAKTI to support domestic biologics production for five years.
Historical / institutional background	This links to technology governance, innovation, industrial policy, and digital regulation.
Legal / institutional origin	Biopharma industrial support inside the Budget
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Earlier tech or industrial policy framework; 2026: New tech-related policy or bill
Static linkage	Science and technology policy, digital regulation, AI, data, semiconductors, and industrial ecosystems.
UPSC relevance	Useful for GS III and for future-oriented mains answers on innovation and regulation.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Earlier tech or industrial policy framework	Sets the base
2026	New tech-related policy or bill	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Sci-Tech / Economy	Science and technology policy	Science and technology policy, digital regulation, AI, data, semiconductors, and industrial ecosystems.
Tech	Biotech policy	Useful for GS III and for future-oriented mains answers on innovation and regulation.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Biopharma industrial support inside the Budget	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

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Confidence: High

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Sci-Tech / Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
R&D;	Research and Development	Innovation support basis	Technology

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not mix biopharma with generic pharma policy.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not miss the five-year horizon.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for biotech, innovation, and health-industrial policy.	GS III	Biotech policy
Analytical point	It is useful for GS III and essay examples.	GS III	Biotech policy

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: science, tech, and innovation policy	Static syllabus link: science, tech, and innovation policy	High
Revision link	Revision link: ecosystem, regulation, and strategic autonomy	Revision link: ecosystem, regulation, and strategic autonomy	High
Current affairs link	Biopharma SHAKTI scheme	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Tech	Scientific temper	The linkage is through science-based innovation policy.	Use it lightly as an example of research-led development.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The linkage is through science-based innovation policy. Use it lightly as an example of research-led development. This is not a philosophical core topic.

Revision Notes

- The scheme aims to strengthen domestic biologics and biomanufacturing.
- It is relevant for pharma resilience and innovation.
- Use it for biotech, innovation, and health-industrial policy.

Current Affair 10: Revival of legacy industrial clusters scheme

Theme: Industrial policy

Subject: Economy

GS Mapping: GS III

Priority: Medium | Suggested Depth: Basic

Source hook: The Budget proposed a scheme to revive around 200 legacy industrial clusters.

Facts

- Cluster revival supports manufacturing and local supply chains.
- It is useful for MSME and industrial policy answers.
- The idea is to upgrade inherited industrial ecosystems.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	UPSC Use
Cluster revival supports man	Cluster revival supports manufacturing and local supply chains.	Prelims / Mains
It is useful for MSME and in	It is useful for MSME and industrial policy answers.	Prelims / Mains
The idea is to upgrade inher	The idea is to upgrade inherited industrial ecosystems.	Prelims / Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail
Immediate trigger	The Budget proposed a scheme to revive around 200 legacy industrial clusters.
Historical / institutional background	This links to macro policy, fiscal or monetary tools, growth, inflation, credit, and distributional effects.
Legal / institutional origin	Industrial cluster revival under the Budget
Evolution / timeline link	Pre-2026: Existing economic framework and policy cycle; 2026: New data, budget, or RBI decision
Static linkage	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
UPSC relevance	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Historical Timeline of the Main Topic

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters for This CA
Pre-2026	Existing economic framework and policy cycle	Sets the baseline
2026	New data, budget, or RBI decision	Current trigger

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage
Economy	GDP	GDP, GVA, fiscal deficit, monetary policy, markets, banking, and trade policy.
Economy	Industrial policy	Very useful for GS III and for current affairs that need data, policy, and trade-off analysis.

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Industrial cluster revival under the Budget	Policy / Law / Rule / Bill	Primary source context	Prelims / Mains

Daily Mode 2026 UPSC Current Affairs - February 2026

Date range: February 1, 2026 to February 28, 2026

Confidence: High

Related Item	Type	Connection with Current Issue	UPSC Use
Economy	Syllabus area	Static anchor	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning in this CA	Domain
MSME	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise	Likely beneficiaries of cluster revival	Economy

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Exam Use
Concept	Do not confuse clusters with SEZs.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains
Concept	Do not ignore the local employment angle.	Use the source-backed reading and do not overstate the issue.	Prelims / Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition
Analytical point	Use it for industrial policy, jobs, and regional development.	GS III	Industrial policy
Analytical point	It is a simple but useful policy example.	GS III	Industrial policy

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Priority
Static syllabus link	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	Static syllabus link: macroeconomy and public finance	High
Revision link	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	Revision link: budget, survey, and RBI vocabulary	High
Current affairs link	Revival of legacy industrial clusters scheme	This exact current affair	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Economy	Economic justice	The link is indirect through balanced regional development.	Use it as a development-policy example.	GS III	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching: The link is indirect through balanced regional development. Use it as a development-policy example. Keep it short in philosophy answers.

Revision Notes

- Cluster revival supports manufacturing and local supply chains.
- It is useful for MSME and industrial policy answers.
- Use it for industrial policy, jobs, and regional development.